IDEATION PHASE

Empathize & Discover – Empathy Map Canvas

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Date	Team ID	Project Name	Maximum Marks
04 September 2026	_____	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow	4 Marks

Purpose

Understand the needs, behaviours, frustrations and expectations of an IT user who reports an incident and depends on the support team for timely resolution.

User Persona

IT User / Employee – a user who experiences an IT issue and needs support.

Empathy Map

SAYS • "I reported an IT issue and need it resolved." • "Can I know the current status of my incident?" • "Which team is handling my issue?" • "Please provide an update on the resolution."	**THINKS** • Is my incident registered correctly? • When will the issue be resolved? • Has the incident been assigned to the right support team? • Will the incident meet its SLA?
DOES • Reports incidents through available communication channels. • Provides details about the IT problem. • Follows up when the issue is not resolved. • Waits for updates and final resolution.	**FEELS** • Frustrated when the issue is not resolved quickly. • Uncertain when there is little visibility into progress. • Concerned about delays and possible SLA breaches. • Satisfied when updates and resolution are timely.

Pains / Challenges

• Poor incident tracking.
• Incorrect or incomplete classification.
• Delayed assignment and escalation.
• Limited visibility into resolution progress.
• Risk of SLA breaches.

Gains / Needs

• Simple and structured incident reporting.
• Correct classification and priority.
• Fast assignment to the appropriate support team.
• Automatic notifications and escalation.
• Clear status visibility until closure.

Key Insights from the Empathy Map

• Users need a simple and reliable way to report and track incidents.
• Users want clear visibility into incident status and ownership.
• Delayed assignment and escalation can negatively affect the user experience.
• SLA monitoring and notifications can help provide timely action and communication.
• A structured ServiceNow Incident Management lifecycle can address the major user challenges identified above.

Problem Focus

The main user challenge is the lack of visibility, consistency, and timely action throughout the incident lifecycle. The proposed ServiceNow automation should focus on structured incident creation, classification, assignment, SLA monitoring, escalation, notifications, resolution, and closure.

Reference

Empathy Map Canvas – Mural reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas